

Andean cock-of-the-rock

Rupicola peruvianus

In sheltered, moist ravines and river valleys high in the cloud forests of the Andes, male Andean cock-of-the-rock gather to display for the benefit of the watching females. A chorus of squawks accompanies the rather awkward performance, drawing attention even to birds deep within the forest canopy. The males are at risk of predation during courtship, with various forest cats, birds of prey, and snakes likely to attack them. At other times, they are quiet and inconspicuous.

Mud nests

Females, which are not as colorful as the males and have less exaggerated crests, make a cup-shaped nest of mud and saliva, plastered against a rock or inside a small cave. They incubate two eggs for up to a month and feed the hatchlings on their own. The cock-of-the-rock's main diet consists of a range of fruits, supplemented with a supply of insects.



- ↔ 12–13 in (30–32 cm)
- ⚖ 7–10 oz (200–275 g)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🍌 Fruit, insects
- 🏠 🌳



N. to W.
South
America

◁ DISPLAYING MALE

Males compete in communal displays in a tree, bowing, flapping their wings, and calling discordantly. Their actions and sounds intensify if a female appears.

Trueb's cochran frog

Nymphargus truebae

Trueb's cochran frog is a species of glass frog, so-called because its skin is translucent on the underside, making it possible to see its bones and internal organs. This tiny native of the Andean cloud forest is nocturnal, sleeping through the day on leaves in the treetops. The green of the leaves shows through the frog's skin, helping it to blend in easily and stay hidden.

Females lay eggs on leaves above pools of water, and the males guard them until they hatch. The tadpoles plummet into the water below, where they feed among the detritus at the bottom.

yellow-spotted
green skin



△ LONG LIMBS

Trueb's cochran frog is wide-skulled and long-limbed. Its eyes are placed at the top of the head.

- ↔ 7/8–1 in (22.5–25 mm)
- ⚖ Not known
- ⊗ Not known
- 🍌 Insects
- 🏠 🌳
- 📍 S. Peru

Crimson longwing

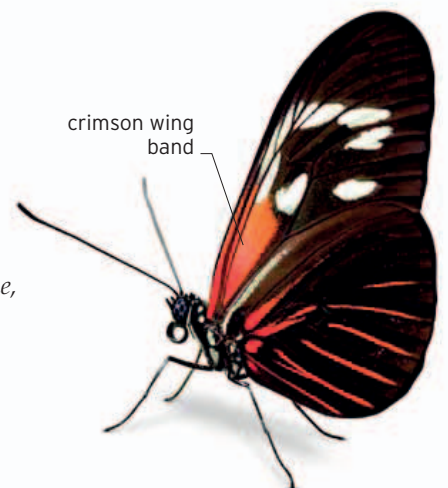
Heliconius erato

Known for its wide, rounded black wings with flashes of red on the upper surface, the crimson-patched longwing is a highly variable butterfly with no fewer than 29 subspecies. Each subspecies has a unique wing pattern, some without any red markings. The species as a whole is found all over Central and South America.

To complicate things further, every subspecies mimics the coloring of the subspecies of another equally variable longwing called the common postman, or *Heliconius melpomene*, that lives in the same habitat.

- ↔ 2–3 in (5.5–8 cm)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Pollen and nectar
- 🏠 🌳
- 📍 Central and South America

crimson wing
band



▷ PERUVIAN NATIVE

The crimson longwing subspecies pictured lives in the lowland forests of Peru.